Claude
BY ANTHROP\C

ciena

ACCOUNT STRATEGY

George Trosley // Enterprise Account Executive

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Why Ciena

Global Networking Leader | $6.3B FY2026 Guidance | 9,000+ Employees | S&P 500

ACCOUNT THESIS

Ciena builds the networking infrastructure AI runs on. They are one of the most important companies in the AI ecosystem, but their internal teams are not using frontier AI to operate the business. That gap between what they enable for others and what they use themselves is the opportunity.

GROWTH UNDER PRESSURE

- 19% revenue growth in FY25
- $7.8B record backlog entering 2026
- Raised guidance to $6.3B
- New CFO driving forecast accuracy
- 33% growth on AI demand alone

KNOWLEDGE WORKER DENSITY

- 9,000+ employees globally
- Blue Planet software engineering
- WaveLogic silicon R&D teams
- Sales ops managing $7.8B backlog
- FP&A under margin pressure

CLAUDE FIT

- Claude Code for Blue Planet devs
- 1M token context for RFP responses
- Enterprise security for IP protection
- Agentic workflows for sales ops
- AI safety alignment for defense work

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$6.3B Revenue | AI Networking Leader | Blue Planet Software Pivot

WHY NOW (COMPELLING EVENTS)

- 33% growth on AI demand. $7.8B backlog under new CFO pressure on forecast accuracy and margin
- S&P 500 inclusion (Feb 2026) puts institutional scrutiny on operational efficiency. AI adoption is now a margin story
- Blue Planet software pivot accelerating. Engineering headcount growing. Developer productivity tooling is the gap

WHAT'S ACTUALLY BROKEN

- Finance, ops and sales running off different versions of backlog and fulfillment data. Millions in unmanaged margin exposure
- Blue Planet engineering scaling without frontier AI tooling. Review cycles and context switching eating velocity
- RFP teams manually assembling proposals across a product portfolio that has doubled in complexity

MY HYPOTHESIS

"Ciena builds the infrastructure AI runs on. Their risk is that every other company on their network is using frontier AI to operate, and they are not. That gap is widening every quarter."

PROOF POINT I NEED

Show measurable developer velocity gain on one Blue Planet sprint within 2 weeks of deployment

IF THIS LANDS

Expand into FP&A (forecast automation), Sales Ops (backlog intelligence), RFP response, supply chain

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Execution | How I'd Win

FIRST WORKLOAD

- Claude Code for Blue Planet engineering
- Target: dev velocity, code review, onboarding
- Land with 50 to 100 engineering seats
- Measure: cycle time, PR throughput, onboarding speed

POV PLAN

- ***How much time does your team spend on code review and context switching between repos?***
- If the answer is "too much," Claude Code is the workload
- Deliver: measurable sprint velocity improvement in 2 weeks
- Show hours reclaimed per engineer per week

WHO I'D ENGAGE

- VP Engineering, Blue Planet (Land)
- Director FP&A → CFO (Expand: forecast automation)
- Director Sales Operations (Expand: backlog intelligence)
- CIO / CISO (Enterprise-wide: security, governance, SSO)

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING

- **vs Copilot:** Claude Code wins on agentic tasks and complex codebases. No Microsoft lock-in
- **vs ChatGPT:** Safety posture matters in defense-adjacent infrastructure. Customer data never trains the model
- **vs Databricks:** Claude is the productivity layer, not the data layer. Complementary play

WHY CLAUDE

Claude fits here because Ciena operates in defense-adjacent, IP-sensitive infrastructure. They need an AI partner that leads with safety and data governance. Claude Enterprise offers SSO, SCIM, audit logs, role-based access and a commitment not to train on customer data. Claude Code gives engineering teams an AI-native development workflow. The 1M token context window lets RFP teams ingest entire technical specifications in a single session.

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What This Looks Like in Dollars | Phased Enterprise Deployment

CLAUDE ENTERPRISE DEPLOYMENT VALUE

Weeks, not months

PHASE 1: LAND Month 1 to 3	**100** seats	Blue Planet Engineering	**$72K to $120K** annual recurring
PHASE 2: EXPAND Month 3 to 6	**500** seats	FP&A, Sales Ops, Supply Chain	**$360K to $600K** annual recurring
PHASE 3: SCALE Month 6 to 12	**1,800+** seats	Enterprise-wide rollout	**$1.3M to $2.2M** annual recurring

YEAR 1 ARR POTENTIAL
$1.3M to $2.2M

TOTAL ADDRESSABLE SEATS
9,000+

INITIAL DEPLOYMENT
100 seats

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Expansion Map | From Engineering to Enterprise

BLUE PLANET ENGINEERING

Land

- Claude Code for agentic development
- PR generation and code review
- Repo-aware onboarding for new hires
- Bug triage and debugging workflows

FINANCE & OPERATIONS

Expand

- Forecast automation under new CFO
- Backlog risk analysis across AI deals
- Margin visibility at the deal level
- Supply chain constraint modeling

SALES & GO TO MARKET

Expand

- RFP response acceleration (1M context)
- Competitive intelligence synthesis
- Proposal generation and customization
- Customer-facing technical documentation

ENTERPRISE-WIDE

Scale

- Internal knowledge base and search
- Policy and compliance documentation
- Cross-functional reporting and analysis
- Employee onboarding and training

KEY INSIGHT

If Ciena is already using Claude, it's most likely not at scale. The land motion is not education. It is proving that what a few teams already trust can transform every function. Each expansion is designed to validate a hypothesis quickly, not assume one.

Summary & Prioritization

#	WORKLOAD	PROOF POINT	PIVOT IF NEEDED
1	Claude Code for Blue Planet engineering	Sprint velocity gain in 2 weeks	RFP response acceleration
2	FP&A forecast automation + backlog intelligence	Margin visibility on 2 to 3 AI deals in 24 hrs	Supply chain constraint visibility
3	Enterprise-wide Claude deployment	20%+ seat adoption in Year 1 (1,800 seats)	Department-by-department rollout

CLOSING POSITION

- I am positioning Claude as the intelligence layer for how Ciena's teams write, analyze, build and make decisions. From engineering to finance to go-to-market.
- Each motion starts small on purpose. I am not trying to win the account in one motion. I am trying to prove value quickly, then expand based on what the business actually needs.
- Each motion is designed to validate a hypothesis quickly, not assume one.

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George Trosley | Enterprise Account Executive | March 2026